

Examiner
only

3. Alpha Centauri is a star of similar size to our Sun.
It is 4.37 light years from Earth.
It is a main sequence star.

(a) State how long light takes to travel from Alpha Centauri to Earth. [1]

time =

(b) (i) Explain, in terms of named forces, why Alpha Centauri is currently stable. [2]

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(ii) Explain, in terms of named forces, the next stage in the life of Alpha Centauri. [2]

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(c) Explain why the mass of hydrogen present in Alpha Centauri will decrease as it gets older. [2]

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